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Paradigm Shift to the Integrative Big-Five Trait Taxonomy:
History, Measurement, and Conceptual Issues

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Running head: Big Five Trait Taxonomy

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APPENDIX A: Big Five Inventory Response Form and Instructions to Participants

Instructions: Here are a number of characteristics that may or may not apply to you. For example, do you agree that you are someone who *likes to spend time with others*? Please write a number next to each statement to indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with that statement.

1	2	3	4	5
Disagree Strongly	Disagree a little	Neither agree nor disagree	Agree a little	Agree strongly

I see myself as someone who...

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. _____ Is talkative | 23. _____ Tends to be lazy |
| 2. _____ Tends to find fault with others | 24. _____ Is emotionally stable, not easily upset |
| 3. _____ Does a thorough job | 25. _____ Is inventive |
| 4. _____ Is depressed, blue | 26. _____ Has an assertive personality |
| 5. _____ Is original, comes up with new ideas | 27. _____ Can be cold and aloof |
| 6. _____ Is reserved | 28. _____ Perseveres until the task is finished |
| 7. _____ Is helpful and unselfish with others | 29. _____ Can be moody |
| 8. _____ Can be somewhat careless | 30. _____ Values artistic, aesthetic experiences |
| 9. _____ Is relaxed, handles stress well | 31. _____ Is sometimes shy, inhibited |
| 10. _____ Is curious about many different things | 32. _____ Is considerate and kind to almost everyone |
| 11. _____ Is full of energy | 33. _____ Does things efficiently |
| 12. _____ Starts quarrels with others | 34. _____ Remains calm in tense situations |
| 13. _____ Is a reliable worker | 35. _____ Prefers work that is routine |
| 14. _____ Can be tense | 36. _____ Is outgoing, sociable |
| 15. _____ Is ingenious, a deep thinker | 37. _____ Is sometimes rude to others |
| 16. _____ Generates a lot of enthusiasm | 38. _____ Makes plans and follows through with them |
| 17. _____ Has a forgiving nature | 39. _____ Gets nervous easily |
| 18. _____ Tends to be disorganized | 40. _____ Likes to reflect, play with ideas |
| 19. _____ Worries a lot | 41. _____ Has few artistic interests |
| 20. _____ Has an active imagination | 42. _____ Likes to cooperate with others |
| 21. _____ Tends to be quiet | 43. _____ Is easily distracted |
| 22. _____ Is generally trusting | 44. _____ Is sophisticated in art, music, or literature |

Please check: Did you write a number in front of each statement?

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Appendix B: Scoring the BFI Scales and Acquiescence Index, and Ipsatizing the BFI Items

Computing Simple BFI Scale Scores

BFI scale scoring: Reverse score the items labeled “R” and compute scale scores as the *mean* of the following items:

Extraversion (8 items): 1, 6R, 11, 16, 21R, 26, 31R, 36;
 Agreeableness (9 items): 2R, 7, 12R, 17, 22, 27R, 32, 37R, 42;
 Conscientiousness (9 items): 3, 8R, 13, 18R, 23R, 28, 33, 38, 43R;
 Neuroticism (8 items): 4, 9R, 14, 19, 24R, 29, 34R, 39;
 Openness (10 items): 5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35R, 40, 41R, 44

Computing the Content-Balanced Acquiescence Index and Ipsatizing the BFI Items

To index individuals’ acquiescent response style (where high scores mean “yeah-saying” and low scores mean “nay-saying”), we compute their acquiescence score as their mean response across 32 BFI items that form 16 pairs of items with opposite implications for personality (e.g., item 1 “Is talkative” and item 21 “Tends to be quiet”). As described in Soto, John, Gosling, and Potter (2008), we devised these 16 pairs of opposite items on the basis of item content and the size of their (negative) interitem correlations. Using the standard BFI item numbers (see Appendix A; also Benet-Martínez & John, 1998; John & Srivastava, 1999), these item pairs are 1 and 21, 6 and 16, 31 and 36, 2 and 17, 7 and 12, 27 and 42, 32 and 37, 3 and 43, 8 and 13, 18 and 33, 23 and 28, 9 and 19, 24 and 29, 34 and 39, 5 and 35, 30 and 41.

The SPSS syntax given below first computes each person’s acquiescence score (“bfiave”; the average of his or her 16x2=32 item responses) and response extremeness (“bfistd”; the standard deviation of that person’s 32 item responses). Both of these individual-difference scores may be retained and used in research on individual or group differences in response-scale use (e.g., comparing Asian-Americans and European-Americans). The syntax below shows how these two scores can be used to ipsatize the full set of 44 BFI items, by removing from each item score the individual’s acquiescence score (i.e., content-balanced response mean) and then

adjusting the resulting deviation scores by dividing them by the individual's standard deviation, resulting in person-centered standard (or *Z*) scores. The syntax below assumes that the variables for the 44 BFI items are named bfi1 to bfi44 in standard order.

SPSS Syntax to Ipsatize the 44 BFI Items Before Scoring the Scales

```
* Compute within-person response means (bfiave) and standard deviations
(bfistd) .

COMPUTE bfiave = mean(bfi1, bfi6, bfi16, bfi21, bfi31, bfi36, bfi2, bfi7,
bfi12, bfi17, bfi27, bfi32, bfi37, bfi42, bfi3, bfi8, bfi13, bfi18, bfi23,
bfi28, bfi33, bfi43, bfi9, bfi19, bfi24, bfi29, bfi34, bfi39, bfi5, bfi30,
bfi35, bfi41) .

COMPUTE bfistd = sd(bfi1, bfi6, bfi16, bfi21, bfi31, bfi36, bfi2, bfi7,
bfi12, bfi17, bfi27, bfi32, bfi37, bfi42, bfi3, bfi8, bfi13, bfi18, bfi23,
bfi28, bfi33, bfi43, bfi9, bfi19, bfi24, bfi29, bfi34, bfi39, bfi5, bfi30,
bfi35, bfi41) .
EXECUTE.

* Compute ipsatized BFI items (zbfi) .

COMPUTE zbfi1 = (bfi1-bfiave)/bfistd.
COMPUTE zbfi2 = (bfi2-bfiave)/bfistd.
COMPUTE zbfi3 = (bfi3-bfiave)/bfistd.
.
.
.
COMPUTE zbfi44 = (bfi44-bfiave)/bfistd.
EXECUTE.
```

Then use the ipsatized item scores to compute scale scores as mean item responses as described above.